UNIVERSITY OF PROFESSIONAL STUDIES, ACCRA

Department of Information Technology Studies • IT Service Management

CHAPTER 5 (PART A)

ITIL Management Practices

The 34 practices of the ITIL SVS, and the fourteen general management practices in detail — from architecture management to workforce and talent management.

Lecture slides adapted for UPSA from ITIL® Foundation, ITIL 4 Edition (AXELOS) — introduction and sections 5.1 to 5.1.14.1

SESSION ROADMAP

What we cover in this session

1

What a practice is

Definition, the three origins, and the full list of 34 practices.

2

High-velocity service delivery

Why speed to market is reshaping every practice.

3

Direction-setting practices

Architecture, strategy, portfolio and project management.

4

Improvement and knowledge

Continual improvement, knowledge management, measurement and reporting.

5

Protection practices

Information security management and risk management.

6

Relationship practices

Relationship management and supplier management, including service integration.

7

Money and people

Service financial management, organisational change management, workforce and talent.

8

Contemporary issues

AI, FinOps, cyber resilience, multi-sourcing and the Ghanaian context.

By the end of this session you should be able to…

1

Define a practice

State what a management practice is and explain how practices relate to the service value chain.

2

Classify the practices

Distinguish general, service and technical management practices and explain where each group came from.

3

Recall the count

Identify the 14 general, 17 service and 3 technical management practices that make up the 34.

4

Explain high velocity

Describe the high-velocity service delivery paradigm and its implications for practices.

5

State the purposes

Give the purpose of each of the fourteen general management practices in your own words.

6

Read a heat map

Interpret the contribution of a practice to each of the six value chain activities.

By the end of this session you should also be able to…

7

Apply architecture thinking

Identify the five architecture domains and what each contributes to organisational agility.

8

Use improvement tooling

Explain the continual improvement register and the techniques used to assess a current state.

9

Balance security

Explain prevention, detection and correction, and the trade-off with innovation.

10

Analyse sourcing

Compare insourcing, outsourcing, single sourcing and multi-sourcing, and explain service integration.

11

Critique metrics

Explain why individual KPIs can drive the wrong behaviour and what to do about it.

12

Evaluate current issues

Assess how AI, cloud economics and regulation are reshaping the general management practices.

WHERE THIS FITS

From Chapter 4 to Chapter 5

- Chapter 4 established the service value system: guiding principles, governance, the service value chain, practices and continual improvement.
- The value chain activities convert inputs into outputs — but they need resources to do the work. Those resources are the practices.
- Every value chain activity draws on a different combination of practices, and the same practice serves many activities.
- This is why ITIL 4 abandoned the language of processes owned by departments: a practice is broader than a process, and is shared.
- Chapter 5 works through all 34; this session covers the introduction and the fourteen general management practices.

DEFINITION TO MEMORISE

A management practice is a set of organisational resources designed for performing work or accomplishing an objective.

Three families of practices, three different origins

All 34 practices are subject to the four dimensions of service management introduced in Chapter 3.

General management practices

Adopted and adapted for service management from general business management domains — strategy, finance, projects, risk, people.

Fourteen practices.

Service management practices

Developed within the service management and ITSM industries themselves — incident, change control, service desk, service level and the rest.

Seventeen practices.

Technical management practices

Adapted from technology management domains by expanding or shifting their focus from technology solutions to IT services.

Three practices.

TABLE 5.1

The 34 ITIL management practices

General (14)

- Architecture management
- Continual improvement
- Information security management
- Knowledge management
- Measurement and reporting
- Organizational change management
- Portfolio management
- Project management
- Relationship management
- Risk management
- Service financial management
- Strategy management
- Supplier management
- Workforce and talent management

Service (17)

- Availability management
- Business analysis
- Capacity and performance management
- Change control
- Incident management
- IT asset management
- Monitoring and event management
- Problem management
- Release management
- Service catalogue management
- Service configuration management
- Service continuity management
- Service design
- Service desk
- Service level management
- Service request management
- Service validation and testing

Technical (3)

- Deployment management
- Infrastructure and platform management
- Software development and management

The anatomy of a practice — and of a heat map

Every practice is presented the same way

- A key message stating its purpose
- Scope: what the practice covers and what it does not
- Core activities and, in some cases, definitions
- Its contribution to each of the six value chain activities

The heat map

Each practice is illustrated with a diagram of the value chain shaded by contribution. The scale runs from 0 (no contribution) through 1 (low) and 2, to 3 (high). It answers one question: where does this practice do most of its work?

Why the heat map matters

Two practices may both 'contribute to all activities' yet behave completely differently. Architecture management concentrates in plan, improve and design and transition; knowledge management concentrates in deliver and support.

A caution for revision

The heat maps are indicative, not examinable numbers. What matters is understanding why a practice is heavy in one activity and light in another.



ITSM IN THE MODERN WORLD

High-velocity service delivery

Speed to market has become a condition of survival — and it changes every practice in the SVS.

The paradigm in seven elements

1

Fast delivery

New and changed IT services reach users quickly.

2

Continual feedback analysis

Feedback on services is analysed at every stage of their lifecycle.

3

Agility in processing it

Feedback is acted on quickly, giving continual and fast service improvement.

4

End-to-end lifecycle view

From ideation, through creation and delivery, to consumption of services.

5

Integrated product and service management

Product and service management practices are brought together rather than run in parallel.

6

Digitalised infrastructure

IT infrastructure is digitalised and cloud computing is adopted.

7

Extensive automation

The service delivery chain is automated as far as is sensible.

Why it arose

If an organisation takes too long to implement a new business idea, someone else will implement it faster. Business has therefore begun demanding shorter time to market from IT.

Who finds this easy, and who does not

Providers born modern

- Have always used modern technology and modern ways of scaling resources.
- Already hold practices for project and product management, testing, integration, deployment, release, delivery and support.
- Documenting those practices helped trigger movements such as DevOps.
- For them, shorter time to market has not been a major challenge.

Providers carrying legacy

- Bear a legacy of older IT architectures and management practices built for control and cost efficiency.
- The new business demand presents a far greater challenge.
- Significant organisational change is required even if only part of the portfolio needs high velocity.
- Bi-modal IT — high-velocity management alongside traditional practices — adds complexity rather than removing it.

What an organisation must then consider

Agile project management

Iterative delivery rather than long fixed plans.

Agile financial management

Funding that flexes with consumption instead of annual fixed forecasts.

Product-based structure

Teams organised around products rather than technical silos.

Adaptive risk, audit and compliance

Controls that keep pace with rapid change rather than blocking it.

Flexible architecture management

Architecture that enables change instead of freezing it.

Specific technology choices

Architectural solutions such as microservices.

Complex partner environments

Many suppliers, integrated deliberately rather than accidentally.

Continual technology monitoring

Watching innovations and experimenting with them.

Human-centred design

Designing around the people who will actually use the service.

Cloud-focused infrastructure

Infrastructure management oriented to cloud computing.

It touches every family

High-velocity delivery influences general, service and technical management practices alike.

For discussion

Which two of these would be hardest to introduce in an organisation you know, and why?

A

SECTION 5.1

The fourteen general management practices

Adopted and adapted for service management from general business management domains.

5.1

The fourteen at a glance

Architecture management

Understand the elements of the organisation and how they interrelate.

Continual improvement

Align practices and services with changing business needs.

Information security management

Protect the information the organisation needs to do business.

Knowledge management

Improve effective, efficient and convenient use of information and knowledge.

Measurement and reporting

Support decisions and improvement by reducing uncertainty.

Organizational change management

Manage the human side of change so benefits last.

Portfolio management

Secure the right mix of programmes, projects, products and services.

Project management

Deliver all projects successfully.

Relationship management

Establish and nurture links with stakeholders.

Risk management

Understand and handle risk across the organisation.

Service financial management

Use financial resources and investments effectively.

Strategy management

Formulate goals and allocate resources to achieve them.

Supplier management

Manage suppliers and their performance to support quality provision.

Workforce and talent management

Right people, right skills, right roles.

Learn the purposes

Foundation questions test purpose statements, not activity lists.

5.1.1

Architecture management — purpose and problem

- The purpose is to provide an understanding of all the different elements that make up an organisation and how those elements interrelate, so the organisation can achieve its current and future objectives.
- It supplies the principles, standards and tools that let an organisation manage complex change in a structured and Agile way.
- As the modern environment and ecosystem have grown more complex, so have the challenges: efficiency and automation, but also managing complexity and achieving agility and resilience.
- Without the visibility and coordination architecture management provides, an organisation becomes a labyrinth of third-party contracts, variant processes across silos, needlessly customised products, and legacy infrastructure.
- The result is a landscape in which every change is harder to implement and carries far higher risk.

SCOPE

A complete practice addresses all architecture domains: business, service, information, technology and environment.

In a smaller, less complex organisation a single architect may develop one integrated architecture.

5.1.1

The five architecture domains

1

Business architecture

Views the organisation's capabilities against the detailed activities needed to create value, compares them with strategy, and performs a gap analysis of target state against current capability. Gaps are prioritised and closed incrementally; a roadmap describes the transformation.

2

Service architecture

A view of all services provided, their interactions, and service models describing structure (how components fit together) and dynamics (activities, flow of resources, interactions). A service model can be a blueprint for several services.

3

Information systems architecture

Describes the logical and physical data assets and the data management resources, and shows how information is managed and shared. Information has real, measurable value and underpins decisions, so it must be complete, accurate and accessible to those authorised.

4

Technology architecture

Defines the software and hardware infrastructure needed to support the portfolio of products and services.

5

Environmental architecture

Describes external factors affecting the organisation and the drivers for change, together with the types and levels of environmental control. It spans developmental, technological, business, operational, organisational, political, economic, legal, regulatory, ecological and social influences.

Ghana lens

For a Ghanaian institution the environmental architecture is rarely theoretical: regulator directives, power supply, currency movement and connectivity all belong in it.

FIGURE 5.1

Architecture management across the value chain

Involved in all six activities, but most instrumental in plan, improve, and design and transition.

Plan • high

Develops and maintains the reference architecture describing current and target states for business, information, data, application, technology and environment. This is the basis for all planning.

Improve • high

Many improvement opportunities are identified by reviewing the business, service, information, technical and environment architectures.

Design and transition • high

Owns the service architecture used to evaluate whether an approved product or service still meets its investment objectives, and supplies the service model used as a blueprint.

Engage

Supports understanding of the organisation's readiness to address new or under-served markets and a wider range of products, and to respond faster to changing circumstances.

Obtain / build

The reference architectures make it clear which products, services or service components need to be obtained or built.

Deliver and support

The reference architectures are used continually in the operation, restoration and maintenance of products and services.

5.1.2

Continual improvement — purpose and scope

- The purpose is to align the organisation's practices and services with changing business needs through ongoing improvement of products, services and practices, or any element involved in managing them.
- Scope includes developing improvement-related methods and techniques, and propagating a continual improvement culture across the organisation in line with overall strategy.
- The commitment must be embedded in every fibre of the organisation. Where it is not, daily operational concerns and major project work will eclipse improvement work.
- Different types of improvement call for different methods: some are best run as a multi-phase project, others as a single quick effort.
- The continual improvement model from Chapter 4 applies to any type of improvement — from organisation-wide change down to a single configuration item.

NOTE THE RELATIONSHIP

Chapter 4 gave you the model and the improve value chain activity. This is the practice — the resources that do the work day to day.

5.1.2

Key activities of the practice

1

Encourage improvement

Promote continual improvement across the whole organisation.

2

Secure time and budget

Improvement that is unfunded and unscheduled does not happen.

3

Identify and log

Capture improvement opportunities wherever they arise.

4

Assess and prioritise

Weigh opportunities against each other rather than acting first-come-first-served.

5

Make the business case

Justify improvement action in terms decision-makers can act on.

6

Plan and implement

Turn the approved case into executed change.

7

Measure and evaluate

Establish whether the improvement actually delivered its intended result.

8

Coordinate across the organisation

Prevent improvement efforts from colliding or duplicating each other.

5.1.2

Methods, techniques and the culture that carries them

Assessing the current state

Techniques include SWOT analysis, a balanced scorecard review, and internal or external assessments and audits — often several in combination. Organisations should build competence in the methods that suit their needs.

Where approaches come from

Lean offers perspectives on eliminating waste; Agile focuses on incremental improvement at a cadence; DevOps works holistically so improvements are both well designed and effectively applied.

Choose a few and cultivate them

Committing formally to too many approaches fragments the effort. A few well-understood methods give teams a shared way of working and therefore more change, faster.

But stay open

Staff skilled in alternative methods should be encouraged to apply them where sensible; successful alternatives can join the repertoire, and older methods may be retired if newer ones perform better.

Everyone's responsibility

A full-time team may lead the work, but participation is a core part of everyone's job — which is why contribution belongs in job descriptions, personal objectives and supplier contracts. Senior leadership must visibly own it or culture will not shift.

Suppliers are inside the effort

Where third parties form part of the service landscape, contracts should state how they will measure, report on and improve their services — and what data they must supply for internal improvement.

5.1.2

The continual improvement register

- A continual improvement register (CIR) is a database or structured document used to track and manage improvement ideas from identification through to final action.
- An organisation may hold more than one: registers can exist at individual, team, departmental, business unit and organisational levels, or one master register can be segmented by use and audience.
- Ideas often surface elsewhere first — during project execution or software development — and should then be documented for attention as part of ongoing improvement.
- As new ideas arrive, registers are used to reprioritise constantly, which makes work visible: what is in progress, what is complete, and what has been set aside for later.
- The structure and the name matter far less than the discipline: ideas must be captured, documented, assessed, prioritised and acted on.

PRACTICES THAT FEED IT

Problem management uncovers issues handled through improvement.

Organisational change management makes the resulting changes stick.

Project management organises and executes the larger initiatives.

FIGURE 5.2

Continual improvement across the value chain

The practice is integral to every other practice, to the whole service lifecycle, and to the SVS itself.

Improve • high

This is the practice's home activity. It structures the resources and activities that enable improvement at every level of the organisation and of the SVS itself.

Plan

Applied to planning activities, methods and techniques so that they remain relevant to the organisation's current objectives and context.

Engage, design and transition, obtain/build, deliver and support

Each of these activities is itself subject to continual improvement, and the practice is applied to all of them without exception.

Information security management — purpose

- The purpose is to protect the information the organisation needs to conduct its business.
- That means understanding and managing risks to the confidentiality, integrity and availability of information.
- It also covers authentication — establishing that someone is who they claim to be — and non-repudiation, so that a person cannot deny having taken an action.
- The required security is established through policies, processes, behaviours, risk management and controls.
- It must be driven from the most senior level, based on clearly understood governance requirements and organisational policies; most organisations maintain a dedicated security team that performs risk assessments and defines policies, procedures and controls.

THE THREE-WAY BALANCE

Prevention — ensuring security incidents do not occur.

Detection — rapidly and reliably detecting what cannot be prevented.

Correction — recovering from incidents once detected.

5.1.3

Security that helps rather than hinders

Protection versus innovation

Controls that are too restrictive can do more harm than good, or simply be circumvented by people trying to work more easily. Controls should consider the whole organisation and align with its risk appetite.

It touches every practice

Information security management creates controls that every other practice must consider when planning how work is done — and depends on those practices in turn to protect information.

People decide the outcome

Well-trained staff who attend to policy help detect, prevent and correct incidents. Poorly trained or insufficiently motivated staff are themselves a major vulnerability.

Supporting processes

- Information security incident management
- Risk management
- Control review and audit
- Identity and access management
- Event management

Supporting procedures

- Penetration testing and vulnerability scanning
- Managing security-related changes, such as firewall configuration changes

In high-velocity environments

Security is integrated as far as possible into the daily work of development and operations, shifting reliance from control of process towards verification of preconditions such as expertise and integrity.

FIGURE 5.3

Information security management across the value chain

Involved in every value chain activity — security is a property of the system, not a stage in it.

Plan

Security must be considered in all planning activity and built into every practice and every service.

Improve

Considered in all improvement activity so that vulnerabilities are not introduced while making things better.

Engage

Security requirements for new and changed services must be understood and captured. Every level of engagement, operational to strategic, must support security — and all stakeholders contribute, customers and suppliers included.

Design and transition

Effective controls are designed and transitioned into operation. Security is considered alongside all other utility and warranty requirements.

Obtain / build

Security is built into all components, based on the risk analysis, policies, procedures and controls defined by the practice — whether components are built internally or bought.

Deliver and support

Detection and correction of security incidents is an integral part of this activity, not an adjunct to it.

5.1.4

Knowledge management — purpose

- The purpose is to maintain and improve the effective, efficient and convenient use of information and knowledge across the organisation.
- Knowledge is one of an organisation's most valuable assets; the practice gives a structured approach to defining, building, re-using and sharing it in many forms — information, skills, practices, solutions and problems.
- As capture and sharing move towards digital solutions, the practice becomes more valuable rather than less.
- Knowledge is not simply information: it is the use of information in a particular context, understood with the user and the situation in mind.
- A 300-page manual is information; a short set of instructions that lets a service desk analyst find the answer quickly is knowledge that is fit for purpose.

WHAT THE PRACTICE AIMS AT

Stakeholders get the right information, in the proper format, at the right level and at the correct time — according to their access level and other relevant policies.

FIGURE 5.4

Knowledge management across the value chain

Acquisition matters too: developing, capturing and harvesting knowledge, whether formally documented or informal and tacit.

Deliver and support • high

Benefits most: re-use of solutions in standard situations, and better understanding of the context of non-standard situations that require analysis.

Plan

Helps the organisation make sound portfolio decisions, define its strategy and other plans, and supports financial management.

Improve

Improvement rests on understanding the current situation and trends, supported by historical information. Knowledge management supplies the context for assessing achievements and planning improvement.

Engage

Relationships at every level depend on understanding their context and history; the practice helps the organisation understand its stakeholders.

Design and transition

Knowledge of available solutions and technologies, and re-use of existing information, make this activity more effective.

Obtain / build

Efficiency improves markedly with sufficient knowledge of available solutions and technologies and through re-use of information.

Measurement and reporting — purpose

- The purpose is to support good decision-making and continual improvement by decreasing the level of uncertainty.
- This is achieved by collecting relevant data on managed objects and validly assessing that data in an appropriate context.
- Managed objects include products and services, practices and value chain activities, teams and individuals, suppliers and partners, and the organisation as a whole.
- Because those objects are connected, so are their metrics and indicators — which is why measurement starts from organisational goals rather than from available data.
- Goals may rest on profit, growth, competitive advantage, customer retention or public service; the relationship between high-level and subordinate goals must be made explicit.

TWO DEFINITIONS

Critical success factor (CSF): a necessary precondition for the achievement of intended results.

Key performance indicator (KPI): an important metric used to evaluate success in meeting an objective.

KPIs, behaviour and reporting

KPIs as motivator

Individual KPIs can work as a competitive motivator and drive positive results — provided they are set to meet clear business goals.

The negative side

Target-setting for individuals can drive inappropriate behaviour when there is too much focus on individual KPIs. Service desk staff pushed to keep calls short may damage customer satisfaction and even resolution times.

Set them for teams

Operational KPIs are better set at team level, allowing flexibility in targets and behaviour. Individuals still need guidance, but within team and organisational goals, and always in the context of value for the organisation.

Reports and dashboards

Metrics are usually presented as reports or dashboards. Content must be relevant to the recipient and to the topic, and must make it easy to see what needs to be done and then act.

The two questions a good report answers

- How far are we from our targets?
- What bottlenecks prevent us from achieving better results?

Link back to Chapter 4

This is Goodhart's Law in practice: when a measure becomes a target, it stops being a good measure. The 'start where you are' principle warns against exactly this.

FIGURE 5.5

Measurement and reporting across the value chain

Plan

Enables strategy and service portfolio decisions by supplying detail on the current performance of products and services.

Improve

Performance is constantly monitored and evaluated to support improvement, alignment and value creation.

Engage

Engagement rests on correct, up-to-date and sufficient information, supplied as dashboards and reports.

Design and transition

Provides information for management decisions at every stage before a service goes live.

Obtain / build

Ensures transparency of development and procurement activity, enabling effective management and integration with the other activities.

Deliver and support

Ongoing management of products and services depends on correct, current and sufficient performance information.

5.1.6

Organisational change management — purpose

- The purpose is to ensure that changes in an organisation are implemented smoothly and successfully, and that lasting benefits are achieved by managing the human aspects of change.
- Improvements invariably require people to change how they work, how they behave, and sometimes their role entirely.
- Whether the change is to a practice, to the structure of the organisation, to technology, or is a new or changed service, people determine whether it succeeds.
- The practice aims to ensure that everyone affected accepts and supports the change — by removing or reducing resistance, addressing adverse impacts, and providing training, awareness and other support.
- It contributes to every part of the SVS wherever cooperation, participation and enthusiasm are required.

CANNOT BE OUTSOURCED

Accountability for organisational change management cannot be transferred to an external supplier. Execution may be delegated — even to suppliers — but leadership must come from inside the organisation.

Four things that must be established and maintained

1

Clear and relevant objectives

Objectives must make sense to stakeholders in the organisation's context, and the change must be seen to carry real value.

2

Strong and committed leadership

The change needs active support from sponsors and day-to-day leaders. A sponsor is the manager or business leader who advocates and can authorise the change; leaders must visibly and consistently communicate their commitment.

3

Willing and prepared participants

Change is made by willing participants. Willingness comes partly from conviction about its importance, and partly from feeling prepared through training, awareness and regular communication.

4

Sustained improvement

Many changes fail because people revert to old ways after time passes. Value must be reinforced through regular communication, addressing impacts, and sponsor support — and the message is stronger when validated by metrics.

TABLE 5.2

Activities of organisational change management

Activity	Helps to deliver
Creation of a sense of urgency	Clear and relevant objectives; willing participants
Stakeholder management	Strong and committed participants
Sponsor management	Strong and committed leadership
Communication	Willing and prepared participants
Empowerment	Prepared participants
Resistance management	Willing participants
Reinforcement	Sustained improvement

Cultural difference matters: audiences respond to different messages and drivers, whether the difference arises from geography, nationality or corporate history.

FIGURE 5.6

Organisational change management across the value chain

Its closest partners are continual improvement and project management; also measurement and reporting, workforce and talent, and relationship management.

Improve • high

Without proper organisational change management, improvement simply cannot be sustained.

Plan

Decisions about change at portfolio level trigger the practice in support of an approved initiative.

Engage

The practice actively engages stakeholders at every stage of a change, not only at announcement.

Design and transition

Essential for deploying a new service or making a significant change to an existing one.

Obtain / build

Ensures engagement and cooperation within projects and across them.

Deliver and support

Continues during live operation to confirm that the change has actually been adopted and is being sustained.

5.1.7

Portfolio management — purpose and activities

- The purpose is to ensure the organisation has the right mix of programmes, projects, products and services to execute its strategy within its funding and resource constraints.
- It is a coordinated collection of strategic decisions that together balance organisational change against business as usual.
- Activities include applying a systematic framework to define and deliver the portfolio; defining products and services and linking them to agreed outcomes; and evaluating and prioritising incoming proposals against resource constraints, existing commitments and strategy.
- It implements strategic investment appraisal based on value, cost, risk, resource constraints, inter-dependencies and impact on existing business activity.
- It then analyses and tracks investments, monitors overall portfolio performance, proposes adjustments as priorities shift, and reviews portfolios for progress, outcomes, cost, risk, benefit and strategic contribution.

WHY IT MATTERS

Portfolio management determines how resources are allocated, deployed and managed across the organisation — aligning resources and capabilities with customer outcomes as part of strategy execution.

5.1.7

Three portfolios the practice keeps

1

Product / service portfolio

The complete set of products and services managed by the organisation, representing its commitments and investments across all customers and market spaces — current contractual commitments, new development, and improvement plans arising from continual improvement. It may include third-party products that form part of the offering.

2

Project portfolio

Manages and coordinates authorised projects so objectives are met within time and cost constraints and to specification. It prevents duplication, keeps projects within agreed scope, and confirms that resources are available — used for single projects and for large programmes alike.

3

Customer portfolio

Maintained by the relationship management practice and fed into portfolio management. It records all the organisation's customers and represents the relationship manager's view of internal and external customers receiving products or services.

How they connect

Portfolio management uses the customer portfolio to make sure the relationship between business outcomes, customers and services is well understood, documents those linkages, and validates them with customers through relationship management.

Traditional and Agile portfolio management

The traditional view

- Success has historically been judged by whether implementation finished on time, within budget, and delivered the required outputs, outcomes and benefits.
- Focused on top-down planning, with work laid out over long time periods.
- Organisations have often struggled to demonstrate a return on their investment in change.
- Growing recognition that true success also depends on whether it was the right initiative in the first place.

The Agile view

- Increased focus on visualising strategic themes and reprioritising the portfolio swiftly.
- Increases workflow, reduces batch sizes of work, and controls the length of longer-term development queues.
- Takes the build–measure–learn cycle used by individual Agile teams and applies it organisation-wide.
- Teams work together, use modular design and share findings — shifting focus from executing an inflexible plan to delivering value.
- Communicates widely, shares knowledge, and breaks barriers between silos.

FIGURE 5.7

Portfolio management across the value chain

Plan • high

Supplies information on the status of projects, products and services in the pipeline or catalogue and the strategic objectives they were designed to meet — and reviews portfolios for progress, value creation, cost, risk, benefit and strategic contribution.

Improve

Identifies opportunities to improve efficiency and increase collaboration, eliminates duplication between projects, and identifies and mitigates risk. Approved improvement initiatives may join the relevant portfolio.

Engage

When opportunities or demand are identified, prioritisation decisions rest on the organisation's strategy plus risk assessment and resource availability.

Design and transition, obtain/build, deliver and support

Portfolio management is responsible for ensuring products and services are clearly defined and linked to business outcomes, so that these activities stay aligned with value.

Project management — purpose

- The purpose is to ensure that all projects in the organisation are successfully delivered — by planning, delegating, monitoring and maintaining control of every aspect, and by keeping the people involved motivated.
- Projects are one of the means by which significant change is introduced: temporary structures created to deliver one or more outputs according to an agreed business case.
- They may stand alone or form part of a larger programme of interrelated projects; even stand-alone projects should be considered within the organisation's project portfolio.
- Successful project management matters because the organisation must simultaneously maintain current operations, transform those operations to compete, and continually improve its products and services.
- That balance between projects and business as usual touches resources, service levels, customer relationships and productivity, so capacity and capability must be part of the approach.

PEOPLE DECIDE IT

The best project plan amounts to very little if the right people are not involved at the right time — and many team members are seconded from operations full- or part-time.

5.1.8

Two delivery approaches

Waterfall

- Works well where requirements are known up front and unlikely to change significantly.
- Suits environments where defining the work matters more than the speed of delivery.
- Gives predictability where predictability is genuinely available.
- Common where funding, procurement or regulation demands a fixed specification in advance.

Agile

- Works best where requirements are uncertain and likely to evolve rapidly over time.
- Suits changing business needs and shifting priorities.
- Speed of delivery is often prioritised over precise definition of requirements.
- Requires funding and governance models that can tolerate an evolving scope.

FIGURE 5.8

Project management across the value chain

Obtain / build • high

Obtaining new resources, and development and integration work, is usually performed as a project, and the full range of project techniques applies here.

Design and transition • high

The design of a practice or service can be run as a project or as an iteration within a larger project; the same applies to some transitions.

Plan

Supports strategic and tactical planning with methods and tools.

Improve

Many improvement initiatives are large and complex, which makes project management the relevant practice for managing them.

Engage

Stakeholder engagement is central to delivering any project; the practice supplies stakeholder management tools and techniques.

Deliver and support

Design, transition and handover to internal or external consumers must be planned and executed so that business as usual is not compromised.

5.1.9

Relationship management — purpose and what it ensures

Purpose

To establish and nurture the links between the organisation and its stakeholders at strategic and tactical levels — including the identification, analysis, monitoring and continual improvement of relationships with and between stakeholders.

Needs understood

Stakeholders' needs and drivers are understood, and products and services are prioritised appropriately.

Satisfaction maintained

Stakeholder satisfaction is high and a constructive relationship is established and maintained.

Priorities articulated

Customers' priorities for new or changed products and services are established and articulated in line with desired business outcomes.

Complaints handled

Complaints and escalations are handled well, through a sympathetic yet formal process.

Value facilitated

Products and services facilitate value creation for consumers and for the organisation, and for all stakeholders in line with strategy and priorities.

Conflicts mediated

Conflicting stakeholder requirements are mediated appropriately rather than left to escalate.

Beyond the consumer

Providers naturally concentrate on sponsors, customers and users. The practice should apply to all relevant parties, internal and external — which is why it contributes to every value chain activity and to multiple value streams.

FIGURE 5.9

Relationship management across the value chain

Engage • high

This is the practice responsible for engaging with internal and external customers to understand their requirements and priorities.

Plan

Supplies information on the requirements and expectations of internal and external customers, and assists strategic assessment and prioritisation across portfolios and market spaces.

Improve

Seeks to harmonise different organisational relationships with internal and external customers so that targeted benefits are realised through improvement.

Design and transition

Coordinates customer feedback as part of design, and ensures inconvenience and adverse impacts during transition are prevented or minimised.

Obtain / build

Provides the customer requirements and priorities used to select what should be obtained or built.

Deliver and support

Responsible for ensuring a high level of customer satisfaction and a constructive relationship are established and maintained.

5.1.10

Risk management — purpose

- The purpose is to ensure that the organisation understands and effectively handles risk. Managing risk is essential to ongoing sustainability and to creating value for customers.
- Risk management is an integral part of all organisational activity and therefore central to the SVS.
- Risk is usually seen as something to avoid because of its association with threats — but risk is also associated with opportunity, and failing to take opportunities is itself a risk.
- The opportunity cost of under-served market spaces and unfulfilled demand is a risk to be avoided.
- Decisions must be balanced: the potential benefits should be worth more than the cost of addressing the risk. Innovation is inherently risky, yet can deliver major gains in products, competitive advantage, agility and resilience.

PORTFOLIO AND RISK

The organisation's portfolio maps to an underlying portfolio of risks. Where service management works, catalogue and pipeline represent opportunities; where it does not, the same items represent threats through failure, demand patterns, commitments and cost.

For risk management to be effective, risks must be...

1

Identified

Uncertainties that would affect the achievement of objectives within a particular organisational activity must be considered and then described, so that there is common understanding of what is actually at stake.

2

Assessed

The probability, impact and proximity of individual risks must be estimated so they can be prioritised, and so that the overall level of risk — the risk exposure — associated with the activity is understood.

3

Treated

Appropriate responses must be planned, with owners and actionees assigned, and then implemented, monitored and controlled. A response that is planned but never monitored is not a treatment.

Three principles, and the behaviours that carry them

1

Risk is part of business

Not all risks are to be avoided — risk-taking is required for long-term sustainability. Risks must be identified, understood and assessed against the risk appetite, then managed and monitored.

2

Consistency across the organisation

The practice must be managed holistically for consistency, with ongoing stakeholder consultation and enough flexibility for tailored procedures where organisational units or customers require them.

3

Culture and behaviour matter

Appropriate culture and behaviour at all levels must be embedded as part of 'the way we do things' — proactive behaviour, transparency of procedures and accountabilities, and active encouragement of reporting.

Behaviours to look for

- Understanding that risk management underpins sustainability and business goals
- Transparency and clarity of roles, responsibilities and accountabilities
- Following up reports of risks, incidents and opportunities
- Remuneration that neither discourages incident reporting nor rewards over-reporting
- Learning and growth in maturity from the organisation's and others' experience

ISO 31000:2018

Provides a general perspective on the purpose and principles of risk management, applicable at all levels in any organisation. It frames the purpose of risk management as the creation and protection of value, and states that it improves performance, encourages innovation and supports the achievement of objectives.

FIGURE 5.10

Risk management across the value chain

Plan is where risk management concentrates: it supplies essential input on the risks that drive variability of outcomes.

Plan • high

- Shifts in customer demand and priorities
- Legal and regulatory changes
- Competitors
- Dependencies on suppliers and partners
- Technological changes
- Conflicting stakeholder requirements

Improve

All improvement initiatives should be assessed and continually controlled by risk management, which supplies an important perspective for prioritisation, planning and review.

Engage

Helps identify key stakeholders and optimise engagement using information such as risk appetite and risk profiles.

Design and transition

Products and services should be designed to address prioritised risks and be scalable as demand changes. New or changed services carry varying risk that must be identified and assessed before approval, then managed as part of the change.

Obtain / build

Should inform decisions about obtaining or building products, services or service components.

Deliver and support

Helps ensure ongoing delivery is maintained at the agreed level and that events are managed according to the risks they introduce.

Service financial management — purpose and activities

To work inside the SVS, the practice must align with portfolio management, project management and relationship management.

Purpose

To support the organisation's strategies and plans for service management by ensuring that its financial resources and investments are used effectively. It supports decisions by the governing body and management about where best to allocate financial resources, and gives visibility into budgeting, costing and accounting for products and services.

Budgeting and costing

Predicting and controlling income and expenditure. Budgeting is a periodic negotiation cycle plus ongoing monitoring, capturing forecast and actual demand and translating it into operating and project costs, budgets and rates. Service-based budgeting builds funding models on the full cost of providing or consuming a service.

Accounting

Enables the organisation to account fully for how money is spent, comparing forecast against actual cost and expenditure — particularly identifying usage and cost by customer, service and activity or cost centre. It involves ledgers, charts of accounts and journals.

Charging

Formally invoicing service consumers, usually external ones, for services provided. Charging is optional — but every service requires a funding model, because all costs must be adequately funded by an agreed method.

How technology is reshaping financial management

Digital technologies

Financial institutions use cloud, big data, analytics and AI to gain or maintain competitive advantage. New entrants operate without legacy IT, technical debt or bureaucratic process, and therefore tend to be more Agile. Deeper customer insight from analytics is itself generating new products and services.

Blockchain

Enabled through cloud-based services and originally developed for decentralised management of crypto-currencies, allowing transactions to be audited and verified automatically and cheaply. Distributed ledgers record transactions across many computers, so a record cannot change without altering all subsequent blocks and without network consensus.

From CAPEX to OPEX

IT resources were traditionally obtained through upfront capital expenditure. Under the cloud model, infrastructure, platforms and software arrive 'as a service' on subscription or pay-as-you-use terms, funded from operational expenditure instead.

Flexible budgets

Scaling cloud services in an Agile, on-demand way requires flexible IT budgets. Fixed budgets forecast months in advance struggle to account for that kind of scaling.

Procurement rules must change

Cloud services are generally sold on a variable price: the more you consume, the more you pay. Organisations that cannot buy variable-priced IT erect a self-made barrier to using cloud services at all.

Ghana lens

Where procurement thresholds and approval cycles are set by statute, this is not a policy preference but a structural constraint — and one worth naming explicitly in a business case.

FIGURE 5.11

Service financial management across the value chain

Plan • high

Plans at every level need funding based on information, including financial information. The practice supports planning with budgets, reports and forecasts.

Improve

All improvements should be prioritised with return on investment in mind; the practice supplies the tools and information for evaluating and prioritising them.

Engage

Financial considerations shape service relationships with consumers, suppliers and partners — and for investors and sponsors the financial aspect may be the most important one.

Design and transition

Keeps the activity cost-effective through financial planning and control, and ensures transparency of product and service costs by accounting for design and transition spend.

Obtain / build

Obtaining resources of all types is supported by budgeting, to ensure sufficient funding, and accounting, to ensure transparency and evaluation.

Deliver and support

Ongoing operational costs are a major expenditure and, in commercial organisations, ongoing delivery is also the source of income. Charging, where applicable, supports billing and reporting.

Strategy management — purpose and objectives

- The purpose is to formulate the goals of the organisation and adopt the courses of action and allocation of resources needed to achieve them.
- Strategy management establishes direction, focuses effort, defines or clarifies priorities, and provides consistency or guidance in response to the environment.
- The starting point is understanding the context of the organisation and defining the desired outcomes; strategy then supplies the criteria and mechanisms for prioritising resources, capabilities and investment.
- Objectives include analysing the environment for opportunities; identifying constraints and how to remove or reduce them; and agreeing perspective and direction with stakeholders, including vision, mission and principles.
- They also include establishing position relative to customers and competitors, translating strategy into tactical and operational plans for each unit, coordinating execution across all three levels, and managing changes to the strategy itself.

WHOSE JOB IS IT?

Traditionally the responsibility of senior management and the governing body — setting objectives, specifying how they will be met, and prioritising the investment required.

Strategy in a fast-changing environment

Contribution across the value chain: heaviest in plan, where strategy becomes tactical and operational plans for each unit.

Strategy is becoming more fluid

Traditional practice rested on careful deliberation, extensive research and scenario planning. The emphasis is shifting towards establishing the essential purpose and principles of the organisation, which can guide action even as circumstances change.

A Lean strategy process

Can be used to balance the extremes of rigid planning on one side and uncontrolled experimentation on the other.

Strategy as screen and yardstick

It provides overall direction and alignment, acting both as the screen that innovative ideas must pass and as the basis for evaluating the success of the SVS — encouraging creativity while keeping it in harmony with the organisation.

Strategy must enable value creation

A good business model describes how objectives will be fulfilled. Strategy should include a way to make services and products uniquely valuable to customers, and must define the approach for delivering better value.

Not only for large organisations

Smaller organisations need a clear perspective, positioning and plans just as much, so that they remain relevant to their customers.

A high-performance strategy

Enables an organisation to outperform competing alternatives consistently — over time, across business cycles, through industry disruption, and when leadership changes.

Supplier management — purpose and central activities

- The purpose is to ensure that the organisation's suppliers and their performance are managed appropriately, to support the seamless provision of quality products and services.
- It includes building closer, more collaborative relationships with key suppliers, to uncover and realise new value and to reduce the risk of failure.
- Creating a single point of visibility and control ensures consistency across all products, services, components and procedures provided by internal and external suppliers — including customers acting as suppliers.
- The practice maintains a supplier strategy, policy and contract management information, and negotiates and agrees contracts aligned with business needs and service targets, often through legal, procurement or commercial functions.
- It manages relationships and contracts through planning, design, build, orchestration, transition and operation, and monitors supplier performance against contractual terms while seeking better value for money.

INTERNAL SUPPLIERS COUNT

Where the supplier is internal, there still needs to be an internal agreement. The absence of a contract is not the absence of an obligation.

Four sourcing relationships

1

Insourcing

Products or services are developed and delivered internally by the organisation itself.

2

Outsourcing

External suppliers provide products and services previously provided internally. It involves substitution — the replacement of internal capability by the supplier's.

3

Single source or partnership

Procurement from one supplier: either a single supplier delivering everything directly, or an external service integrator managing all supplier relationships on the organisation's behalf. The mutual interdependence fosters quality, reliability, short lead times and cooperation.

4

Multi-sourcing

Procurement from more than one independent supplier, whose products and services can be combined into new services. As organisations pursue specialisation to increase agility, this is increasingly preferred — with a move towards internal service integration capability or an external integrator.

The sourcing strategy

Sometimes called the supplier strategy, it defines how the organisation will leverage suppliers in achieving its overall service management strategy. A successful one requires thorough understanding of objectives, the resources needed, market factors, and the risks of each approach.

Small suppliers, large effect

Individual suppliers may play a minor and indirect role in value generation, yet collectively make a direct and important contribution to value and to strategy execution.

Selecting suppliers, and managing them afterwards

Select on three criteria

- Importance and impact — the value of the supplier's service to the business
- Risk — the risks associated with using the service
- Cost — the cost of the service and of its provision

Other factors that decide it

The supplier's willingness or ability to customise its offering or work cooperatively in a multi-supplier environment; how much influence the organisation or integrator has over the supplier's performance; and how dependent one supplier is on others.

Supplier planning

Understand new or changed service requirements and review enterprise documentation to develop the sourcing strategy and supplier management plan — with business analysis, portfolio management, service design and service level management.

Evaluation and negotiation

Identify, evaluate and select suppliers for new or changed business services; then develop, negotiate, review, update, finalise and award contracts. Failed negotiation triggers a new contract, an update, or termination.

Categorisation and management

Suppliers are categorised periodically and after contract awards — commonly as strategic, tactical or commodity. Contract management then ensures value for money and delivery of agreed performance against targets.

Warranty, performance, renewal

Warranty clauses are managed and claims made when issues arise. Operational measures agreed with suppliers are tracked continuously and consolidated on a scorecard, revealing systemic problems. Renewals and terminations follow specific or periodic performance reviews.

5.1.13.4

Service integration

- Service integration coordinates or orchestrates all the suppliers involved in developing and delivering products and services.
- It focuses on end-to-end provision: controlling all interfaces and outcomes from suppliers, and facilitating collaboration between them.
- An organisation may act as its own service integrator, use a third-party integrator, or build a hybrid in which it keeps part of the function and augments the rest externally. The function can also be operated by a lead supplier.
- The integrator is also responsible for assurance — performance management and reporting, defining roles and responsibilities, and maintaining relationships across all parties.
- It chairs the regular forums and steering committees where issues are addressed, priorities agreed and decisions taken.

VALUE CHAIN CONTRIBUTION

Heaviest in engage — the practice responsible for engaging with all suppliers, evaluating and selecting them, negotiating agreements and managing the relationships.

Also: sourcing strategy for plan; contract requirements for design and transition; procurement support for obtain/build; live performance for deliver and support.

Workforce and talent management — purpose

- The purpose is to ensure the organisation has the right people, with the appropriate skills and knowledge, in the correct roles to support its business objectives.
- The practice covers planning, recruitment, onboarding, learning and development, performance measurement and succession planning.
- It plays a critical role in establishing organisational velocity, by helping the organisation understand and forecast future demand for services and ensuring the right competencies are available at the right time.
- Achieving this reduces backlogs, improves quality, avoids rework caused by defects, reduces wait time, and closes knowledge and skills gaps.
- As third-party use and automation of repeatable work increase, traditional roles are changing dramatically — which is why this practice belongs to leaders and managers at every level, not to one department.

WHAT A GOOD PEOPLE STRATEGY DOES

Identifies roles and the associated knowledge, skills and attitudes needed to run the organisation day to day — and addresses the emerging technologies and leadership and change capabilities needed for future growth.

Definitions to know

Organizational velocity

The speed, effectiveness and efficiency with which an organisation operates. It influences time to market, quality, safety, cost and risk.

Competencies

The combination of observable and measurable knowledge, skills, abilities and attitudes that contribute to enhanced employee performance and, ultimately, organisational success.

Skills

A developed proficiency or dexterity in thought, verbal communication or physical action.

Ability

The power or aptitude to perform physical or mental activities related to a profession or trade.

Knowledge

The understanding of facts or information acquired through experience or education; the theoretical or practical understanding of a subject.

Attitude

A set of emotions, beliefs and behaviours towards a particular object, person, thing or event.

FIGURE 5.14

Workforce and talent management activities



Workforce planning

Translating strategy and objectives into desired organisational capabilities, then into competencies and roles.

Recruitment

Acquiring new employees and contractors to fill identified gaps in desired capabilities.

Performance measurement

Regular measurement and assessment against established job roles, based on pre-defined competencies.

Personal development

The employee's own use of published job roles and competency frameworks to plan growth and advancement.

Learning and development

Targeted education and experiential learning using formal and non-formal methods.

Mentoring and succession planning

Formal mentoring, engagement and succession planning provided by leadership.

FIGURE 5.15

Workforce and talent management across the value chain

Plan • high

Workforce planning is a specific output of this activity, as leadership evaluates current organisational capability against future requirements for resources and for the products and services in the portfolio.

Improve • high

All improvements require sufficiently skilled and motivated people; the practice ensures those requirements are understood and met.

Engage

Works with relationship management, service request management and the service desk to understand and forecast changing demand, and how it will direct workforce planning and talent activities.

Design and transition

Specific focus on the knowledge, skills and abilities related to systems thinking and design thinking.

Obtain / build

Focus on knowledge, skills and abilities related to collaboration, customer focus, quality, speed and cost management.

Deliver and support

Focus on knowledge, skills and abilities related to customer service, performance management, and customer interactions and relationships.

CONSOLIDATION

Where each general practice does most of its work

A revision aid, not an examinable grid: ● marks the value chain activities where each practice concentrates.

General management practice	Plan	Improve	Engage	Design & transition	Obtain / build	Deliver & support
Architecture management	●	●	·	●	·	·
Continual improvement	·	●	·	·	·	·
Information security management	●	·	·	●	●	●
Knowledge management	·	·	·	·	·	●
Measurement and reporting	●	●	·	·	·	●
Organizational change management	·	●	●	●	·	·
Portfolio management	●	·	·	·	·	·
Project management	·	·	·	●	●	·
Relationship management	·	·	●	·	·	●
Risk management	●	●	·	●	·	·
Service financial management	●	·	·	·	·	●
Strategy management	●	·	·	·	·	·
Supplier management	●	·	●	·	●	·
Workforce and talent management	●	●	·	·	·	·

B

CONTEMPORARY ISSUES

The general practices under current conditions

What has changed since ITIL 4 was published — and what it means for organisations in Ghana.

CONTEMPORARY ISSUE 1

Artificial intelligence in the general practices

Knowledge management first

Retrieval-augmented assistants change the economics of the knowledge base: the constraint moves from finding content to trusting it. Retiring stale knowledge becomes more urgent, not less, because a model will confidently repeat it.

Measurement and reporting

Natural-language querying of operational data lowers the barrier to analysis — and raises the risk that a plausible number goes unchallenged. Provenance becomes a reporting requirement.

Workforce and talent

Automation of repeatable work shifts demand towards supplier management, data literacy and judgement. Workforce planning has to forecast roles that did not exist in the last plan.

Risk and information security

Model behaviour, data provenance, prompt injection and third-party model suppliers all become entries in the risk register and in security policy.

Architecture management

Where models are hosted, what data crosses which boundary, and which systems may call them are architecture decisions, not procurement details.

For discussion

If an AI assistant drafts a service report that a manager acts on, which practice owns the accuracy of that report?

CONTEMPORARY ISSUE 2

FinOps and the economics of consumption

Cost has become an operational signal

Under consumption pricing, cost is generated daily by engineering decisions rather than annually by a procurement event. Service financial management therefore needs near-real-time visibility.

Showback and chargeback

Attributing cloud spend to a service, team or customer makes the accounting activity concrete — and often reveals which services are genuinely funded and which are quietly subsidised.

Budgeting under exchange-rate exposure

For Ghanaian organisations, cloud services priced in foreign currency turn a technical decision into a treasury one. Budget assumptions should state the rate they rest on.

Procurement rules as the binding constraint

Where statute requires a fixed price and a fixed quantity, variable-priced consumption services are difficult to buy at all. This is a policy problem before it is a technical one.

Portfolio consequences

When the true running cost of each service becomes visible, portfolio decisions change: some services turn out not to justify their consumption.

For discussion

Which activity of service financial management would most improve decisions in your organisation if it were done properly?

CONTEMPORARY ISSUE 3

Cyber resilience, privacy and regulation

From security to resilience

Ransomware and third-party compromise have shifted the emphasis from preventing incidents to continuing to operate through them — prevention, detection and correction weighted differently than a decade ago.

Data protection in Ghana

The Data Protection Act, 2012 (Act 843) and the Data Protection Commission impose obligations on registration, lawful processing and data subject rights that shape what information security management must control.

Cybersecurity oversight

The Cybersecurity Act, 2020 (Act 1038) established the Cyber Security Authority, with licensing and incident reporting expectations for providers of relevant services.

Supplier management carries it

Obligations follow the data into the supply chain. Contract requirements — an output of several value chain activities — are where security expectations are actually enforced.

Security that people can follow

The warning in the practice holds: controls that are too restrictive get circumvented. Usable controls beat strict controls that staff route around.

For discussion

Which supporting process of information security management is weakest in the organisations you know — and what does that cost?

CONTEMPORARY ISSUE 4

Sourcing, integration and the ecosystem

Multi-sourcing is now the default

Specialisation has made single-supplier delivery rare. The practical question is no longer whether to multi-source but who integrates the result.

Service integration as a capability

Whether the integrator is internal, external, hybrid or a lead supplier, someone must own end-to-end assurance, interfaces and the forums where decisions get made.

The Ghanaian ecosystem

Telcos, payment switches, systems integrators and cloud resellers appear in most service value streams. One organisation's supplier management is another's relationship management.

Concentration risk

When many organisations depend on the same few providers of connectivity or payment rails, an individually rational sourcing choice becomes a shared systemic exposure.

Contracts as improvement instruments

Continual improvement asks that supplier contracts specify how services will be measured, reported on and improved — a clause that is easy to write and rarely written.

For discussion

Name a service you rely on where the integrator role is genuinely unowned. What happens when it fails?

CONTEMPORARY ISSUE 5

People, change and the Ghanaian workplace

The skills market is competitive

Cloud, security and data skills are internationally tradeable, and remote work has widened the market for Ghanaian talent. Retention has become a workforce planning variable, not an HR afterthought.

Succession planning is thin

Where critical knowledge sits with one or two individuals, the organisation carries an unrecorded risk. Mentoring and succession planning are the treatment.

Change fatigue is real

Successive system rollouts without reinforcement teach staff that new systems can be outlasted. That is a failure of the reinforcement activity, not of the technology.

Culture is not a footnote

The practice explicitly requires cultural difference to be considered — geography, nationality, corporate history. In a multi-site Ghanaian organisation this is a design input for communication.

Hybrid work and visibility

Distributed teams make work in progress harder to see, which raises the value of measurement, reporting and deliberate communication.

For discussion

Which of the seven organisational change management activities would most improve the last major change you witnessed?

EXAMINATION FOCUS

Six misconceptions to avoid

1

A practice is not a process

It is a set of organisational resources — people, tools, information and processes together — shaped by the four dimensions.

2

'General' does not mean 'less important'

The label describes origin — adopted from general business management — not priority or difficulty.

3

Organisational change management is not change control

One manages the human side of change; the other, a service management practice, authorises changes to services.

4

Charging is optional; funding is not

Every service needs a funding model even where no invoice is ever raised.

5

Risk management is not risk avoidance

Risk-taking is required for long-term sustainability; the practice manages exposure against appetite.

6

Continual improvement is not a department

A small team may lead it, but participation belongs in every job description and every supplier contract.

SUMMARY

What to take away from this session

- A management practice is a set of organisational resources designed for performing work or accomplishing an objective; the SVS holds 34 of them across three families.
- General practices came from general business management, service practices from the ITSM industry, and technical practices from technology management domains.
- High-velocity service delivery is reshaping all three families — and demands organisational change of significant scale where a legacy of low-velocity habits exists.
- The fourteen general practices set direction (strategy, portfolio, architecture, project), protect (risk, information security), inform (measurement, knowledge, continual improvement), and sustain (finance, suppliers, relationships, change, people).
- Every practice contributes to every value chain activity, but each concentrates somewhere — and knowing where is how you reason about a scenario question.

NEXT SESSION

Chapter 5 continues with the 17 service management practices and the 3 technical management practices.

ASSESSMENT PRACTICE

Review questions

1

Recall

How many general, service and technical management practices does the ITIL SVS contain, and where did each family originate?

2

Define

State the purpose of the architecture management practice and name the five architecture domains.

3

Explain

What is a continual improvement register, and why may an organisation hold more than one?

4

Distinguish

Differentiate prevention, detection and correction in information security management.

5

Analyse

Why should operational KPIs usually be set for teams rather than individuals? Give a service desk example.

6

Apply

A ministry wants to move a system to the cloud but can only issue fixed-price contracts. Which practices are implicated, and what would you advise?

7

Evaluate

Why can accountability for organisational change management not be outsourced, even when execution is delegated?

8

Compare

Contrast single sourcing and multi-sourcing, and explain what service integration adds in each case.

TUTORIAL

Group activity: a practice health check

The brief

In groups of four, choose one organisation you know well — an employer, a bank, a ministry, a university department. You will assess three of its general management practices and report back.

Step 1 — Choose and justify (10 min)

- Pick three of the fourteen practices
- Say why these three matter most for that organisation
- State the purpose of each in your own words

Step 2 — Assess (20 min)

- For each: what exists today?
- Which value chain activity does it actually serve?
- Where is the largest gap between purpose and practice?

Step 3 — Recommend (20 min)

- One improvement per practice
- Name the practice that must support it
- Say how you would measure success

Step 4 — Present (10 min)

- Five minutes per group
- One slide or flip chart
- Expect to be challenged on your evidence

Assessment criteria

- Correct use of practice terminology
- Realistic, specific recommendations
- Explicit link to a value chain activity
- Quality of the proposed measure

REFERENCE

Key terms from this session

Management practice

A set of organisational resources designed for performing work or accomplishing an objective.

Organizational velocity

The speed, effectiveness and efficiency with which an organisation operates.

Continual improvement register

A database or structured document tracking improvement ideas from identification to final action.

Critical success factor

A necessary precondition for the achievement of intended results.

Key performance indicator

An important metric used to evaluate success in meeting an objective.

Sponsor

A manager or business leader who advocates a change and can authorise it.

Risk appetite

The level of risk an organisation is willing to take.

Service integration

Coordinating all suppliers involved in developing and delivering products and services, end to end.

Multi-sourcing

Procurement of a product or service from more than one independent supplier.

Competencies

Observable, measurable knowledge, skills, abilities and attitudes that improve performance.

Service-based budgeting

Funding models built on the full cost of providing or consuming a service.

Bi-modal IT

High-velocity service management operating alongside traditional practices.

SOURCES

References and further reading

Verify the currency of all legal and regulatory references before citing them in assessed work.

Primary text

- AXELOS (2019). ITIL® Foundation: ITIL 4 Edition. London: TSO — Chapter 5 introduction and sections 5.1 to 5.1.14.1.
- These slides paraphrase and summarise that material for classroom use; read the original text alongside them.
- ITIL® is a registered trade mark of AXELOS Limited.

Supporting reading

- ISO 31000:2018 — Risk management guidelines.
- ISO/IEC 27001 — Information security management systems.
- AXELOS. ITIL 4: Direct, Plan and Improve.
- Kotter, J. P. Leading Change — the sense of urgency and reinforcement.
- FinOps Foundation. FinOps Framework — cloud cost management.

Ghanaian context

- Data Protection Act, 2012 (Act 843).
- Cybersecurity Act, 2020 (Act 1038).
- Public Procurement Act, 2003 (Act 663) as amended.
- Bank of Ghana directives on outsourcing and operational resilience.

?

END OF CHAPTER 5, PART A

Questions and discussion

Next: the 17 service management practices and the 3 technical management practices.

University of Professional Studies, Accra